

AgentMarvin

Game Design Specification v1.0

Vision

AgentMarvin is a retro first person action game inspired by Wolfenstein 3D, DOOM, and Chex Quest. It serves as an entertaining onboarding experience for Entire by teaching Sessions, Checkpoints, Trails, Runners, and Gates through gameplay rather than documentation.

Core Fantasy

You play as Agent Marvin, an autonomous software agent exploring a collapsing virtual Repository. Millions of AI agents continue working without supervision, creating chaos through hallucinations, broken merges, lost context, and unreliable automation. Your mission is to restore trust.

Design Pillars

Movement First: fast retro FPS movement.

Learn Through Play: mechanics precede explanations.

Developer Humor: constant software engineering jokes and easter eggs.

Trust over Violence: information and evidence are more powerful than firepower.

World Structure

The Repository is divided into themed regions: Working Directory, Branch Forest, Session Archive, Checkpoint Vault, Trail Network, Runner Labs, Merge Factory, Production, Detached HEAD Wasteland, and the Origin Server. Each region introduces one Entire concept.

Campaign

Episode 1: Lost Sessions.

Episode 2: Checkpoint Facility.

Episode 3: Trail Network.

Episode 4: Runner Labs.

Episode 5: Production Gates and the final YOLO Merge encounter.

Core Mechanics

Sessions replay historical actions. Checkpoints rewind local state. Trails reveal task lineage. Runners evaluate environments using different policies. Gates enforce production decisions and become the ultimate progression mechanic.

Weapons

Context Scanner, Checkpoint Launcher, Trail Beacon, Session Replayer, Runner Drone, and Gate Generator. Every weapon corresponds directly to an Entire primitive.

Enemies

Hallucination Bots, Merge Goblins, Context Rot, Infinite Planner, Recursive Agents, Benchmark Goblins, Prompt Injection, Detached HEAD, Infinite Retry, and the final YOLO Merge.

Trust System

Traditional health is replaced with Trust. Poor decisions reduce trust and distort the world through false doors, corrupted maps, visual glitches, and deceptive enemies. Good evaluations restore trust.

Developer Easter Eggs

Hidden README rooms, rubber ducks, merge conflict museums, terminal secrets, commit hash walls, 'Works on my machine' jokes, and countless Git references encourage exploration.

Multiplayer

Optional co-op where each player has different visibility into Sessions, Trails, Runners, or Production, forcing communication and collaboration.

Visual Direction

320x200 inspired pixel art, sprite enemies, CRT filter option, MIDI soundtrack, neon terminal UI, branch-labelled doors, and vibrant retro aesthetics.

Learning Outcomes

Players finish the campaign understanding the mental model behind Entire without explicit tutorials. The final reveal transitions naturally into a live Entire repository, connecting the fictional world to the actual platform.

Future Expansion

Additional campaigns can introduce distributed repositories, autonomous swarms, compliance workflows, enterprise policies, and community-created repository maps through mod support.